

x. Islands

(a) Island groups of the Bay of Bengal

*Among the island groups of the Bay of Bengal the Andaman and Nicobar Islands hold an important place. The Andaman group of Islands is separated from the Nicobar group of islands by a **10° (10 degree channel)**. The width of the channel is approx. **150 km**, and it lies parallel to the 10° North latitude. The Andaman & Nicobar islands are a Union Territory located in the Bay of Bengal. The highest peak of Andaman island group is **Saddle Peak** which is **732** meters above sea level. It is located in North Andaman Island near Diglipur.

The highest peak of the **Nicobar island group** is **Mount Thullier** (642m), which is located on the Great Nicobar island. The Andaman and Nicobar island group consists of **836 islands** (Islands/Islets/Rocky Outcrops). ***Barren Island**, located in the Andaman Sea lies about 135 km, North-East of Port Blair. It is the only active volcano in South Asia and first erupted (recorded) in 1787. The **Narcondam island** is also located in the Andaman Sea, which is a dormant volcano. *The Andaman island group was formed as a result of the extension of the **Arakan Yoma** (a tertiary mountain range). Limestone, sandstone and shale are the most prominent rock features of this island group. *In the Eastern coastal states of Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu, lies **Lake Pulicat**. The lake is famous for being the second largest brackish water lake in India after Chilika Lake. Sriharikota Island is situated near Lake Pulicat. The Island separates the lake from the Bay of Bengal. *The **Satish Dhawan Space Centre** is located on this island and it is used by India for her satellite launch programme. The **Adam's Bridge (Ram Setu)** starts as a chain of shoals from the Dhanushkodi, tip of India's Pamban island and ends at Sri Lanka's Mannar Island.

1. "Saddle peak" the highest peak of Andaman & Nicobar is located in-

- (a) Great Nicobar
- (b) Middle Andaman
- (c) Little Andaman
- (d) North Andaman

I.A.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

Saddle Peak (732 m) is the highest peak of the Andaman Islands, is located near Diglipur on North Andaman Island.

2. Which of the following is the highest peak of Andaman and Nicobar group of islands ?

- (a) Saddle peak
- (b) Mount Thuillier
- (c) Mount Diavolo
- (d) Mount Koyale

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

3. Andaman and Nicobar are –

- (a) Two Islands in Bay of Bengal
- (b) Group of Islands in Bay of Bengal
- (c) Group of Islands in Arabian Sea
- (d) Two Islands in Indian ocean.

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Andaman and Nicobar Island, located in the Bay of Bengal.

4. Number of islands in Andaman and Nicobar is–

- (a) 200
- (b) 240
- (c) 220
- (d) 250

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (*)

The total number of islands (Islands/Islets/Rock Outcrops) in Andaman and Nicobar is 836.

5. Ten Degree Channel separates –

- (a) Andaman from Nicobar Islands
- (b) Andaman from Myanmar
- (c) India from Sri Lanka
- (d) Lakshadweep from Maldives

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

Ten Degree Channel separates Andaman group of Islands from Nicobar group of Islands. The expansion of the channel is about 150 km. It is parallel to 10° North latitude so it is called the ten Degree Channel.

6. Which one of the following pairs of islands is separated from each other by the Ten degree channel'?

- (a) Andaman and Nicobar
- (b) Nicobar and Sumatra
- (c) Maldives and Lakshadweep
- (d) Sumatra and Java

I.A.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Which one of the following pair of island is separated by 10 degree channel ?

- (a) Lakshadweep and Minicoy
- (b) South Andaman and Little Andaman
- (c) Andaman and Nicobar
- (d) Pamban and Mannar

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. Consider the following statements :

1. The Barren Island volcano is an active volcano located in the Indian territory.
 2. Barren Island lies about 140 km east of Great Nicobar.
 3. The last time the Barren Island Volcano erupted was in 1991 and it has remained inactive since then.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only
- (b) 2 and 3
- (c) 3 only
- (d) 1 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

The Barren island is an island located in Andaman Sea, dominated by Barren Volcano, the only confirmed active volcano in South Asia. It is a part of the Indian Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands. Hence statement 1 is correct.

It lies about 135 km, northeast of the Union Territory's capital Port Blair and about 540 km from Great Nicobar. Hence statement 2 is incorrect.

The volcano erupted for the first time (as per the records) in 1787. In 1991 there was another eruption that lasted for about six months and was particularly harmful to island's fauna. However there were eruptions in 1994-95 and 2005-06, the latter considered to be linked to the 2004 Indian Ocean earthquake. Hence statement 3 is incorrect.

9. Barren island is located in-

- (a) Bay of Bengal
- (b) Arabian Sea.
- (c) Mediterranean Sea
- (d) China Sea

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

The Barren Island is located in the Andaman Sea in the Bay of Bengal, about 135 km northeast of Port Blair. It is the only active volcano in South Asia. It first erupted (recorded) in 1787.

10. Which of the following islands of India has a volcanic origin?

- (a) Barren
- (b) Car Nicobar

(c) Little Nicobar

(d) North Andaman

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The Barren Island is located in Andaman Islands. It is the only confirmed active volcano in South Asia. It is a part of the Indian Union Territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

11. Which one of the following is a volcanic island of India?

- (a) Little Andaman
- (b) Little Nicobar
- (c) Great Nicobar
- (d) Barren Island

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. Sriharikota island is located in –

- (a) Near Chilka Lake
- (b) Near the mouth of Mahanadi River
- (c) Near Pulicat Lake
- (d) Near the mouth of Godavari River

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

Sriharikota island is located near Pulicat Lake in Andhra Pradesh. It separates Pulicat Lake from the Bay of Bengal. Satish Dhawan Space Centre is located in Sriharikota.

13. The Adam's Bridge begins from –

- (a) Dhanushkodi
- (b) Mandapam
- (c) Pamban
- (d) Rameshwaram

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

Adam Bridge is also known as 'Ram Setu'. It is spread as a chain of shoals from the tip of Dhanushkodi India's Pamban island to Sri Lanka's Mannar island. Pamban island is semi connected to Indian mainland by the 2.2 km long Pamban Bridge.

14. Which of the following is geographically closest to Great Nicobar?

- (a) Sumatra
- (b) Borneo
- (c) Java
- (d) Sri Lanka

I.A.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (a)

Great Nicobar is the southernmost island of India located between 6°45' N - 7°15' N and 93°37' E - 93°56' E. This is approximately 540 km away from Port Blair, the Indonesian island of Sumatra is geographically closest to Great Nicobar as compared to Borneo, Java and Sri Lanka. Java is an island of Indonesia to the south of Sumatra. Borneo is located to the east of Sumatra.